

Loan Package Checklist

Documents lenders commonly request, by loan type

How to use this checklist

This checklist lists documents lenders **commonly request**. Each lender differs, and your lender may ask for less, more, or something different. Use it to get organized before you apply, so the conversation starts with facts instead of a scramble.

1. Start with the core list. 2. Add the list for your loan type. 3. Check items off as you gather them. 4. Ask your lender for their checklist and compare.

Core items (most business loan requests)

	Document	Notes
☐	Business tax returns, usually the last 2 to 3 years, with all schedules	If a return is on extension, include the extension and your year-end financials.
☐	Personal tax returns for each owner, usually the last 2 to 3 years	Many lenders ask for returns from owners of 20% or more. Ask what threshold your lender uses.
☐	Year-end business financial statements (profit and loss, balance sheet), last 2 to 3 years	CPA-prepared if you have them. Internal statements are often fine for smaller requests.
☐	Interim (year-to-date) financial statements, plus the same period last year	Recent is better. Many lenders want statements from within the last quarter.
☐	Accounts receivable and accounts payable aging reports	Dated the same as your interim statements. Your accounting software can usually print these.
☐	Business debt schedule	Each loan, lease, or line: lender, original amount, current balance, payment, rate, maturity, collateral.
☐	Personal financial statement for each owner or guarantor	Signed and dated. See the PFS walkthrough in this toolkit.
☐	Entity documents	Articles of organization or incorporation, operating agreement or bylaws, ownership breakdown, EIN letter, certificate of good standing.
☐	Government-issued photo ID for each owner and signer	Lenders are required to verify identity.
☐	Recent business bank statements	Often 3 to 12 months. Ask how many your lender wants.
☐	A short written summary of the request	How much, what for, and how it will be repaid. One page is plenty.
☐	Lease for your business location, if you rent	Include the term remaining and any renewal options.
☐	Business insurance summary	Agent name and current coverage. Lenders often require insurance on collateral.

Working-capital line of credit

	Document	Notes
☐	Monthly accounts receivable aging, with customer names	Lenders look at how quickly customers pay and how concentrated your customers are.
☐	Monthly accounts payable aging	Shows how you are managing vendor terms.
☐	Inventory report, if you carry inventory	Type, value, and how it is valued.
☐	12-month cash flow projection	Shows when you expect to draw on the line and when you expect to pay it down. See the cash flow template.
☐	Top customer list and concentration	Share of sales from your largest customers.
☐	Short explanation of seasonality	Especially for landscape, agribusiness, contractors, and other seasonal businesses.

Equipment loan or lease

	Document	Notes
☐	Vendor quote or invoice	Make, model, year, new or used, price, taxes, delivery, and installation.
☐	Serial number or VIN (used equipment and vehicles)	Needed for titling and lien filing.
☐	Trade-in details, if any	What you are trading and the credit you are getting.
☐	How the equipment pays for itself	More jobs, lower repair costs, less rental expense. A few sentences is enough.
☐	Appraisal or valuation for used or specialized equipment	Some lenders require it. Ask first.
☐	Insurance certificate naming the lender	Usually needed before funding.

Term loan or expansion

	Document	Notes
☐	Project budget	Every cost, with quotes or contractor bids where possible.
☐	Financial projections with assumptions	Often 2 to 3 years. Explain the key assumptions in plain words.
☐	Contractor bids and construction contracts (if building out space)	Fixed-price contracts are easier for lenders to evaluate.
☐	Brief expansion plan	Why now, what changes, who manages it, and what happens if sales ramp slower than planned.
☐	Use of proceeds and sources of funds	See the sources and uses worksheet in this toolkit.

Owner-occupied commercial real estate

	Document	Notes
☐	Signed purchase contract or letter of intent	Include all addenda.
☐	Property details	Address, square footage, year built, and how much space your business will occupy.
☐	Appraisal	Usually ordered by the lender. You typically pay for it.
☐	Environmental review	Lenders commonly require some level of environmental review. The level depends on the property and lender.
☐	Title, survey, and zoning information	Often handled by the closing attorney, but have the seller's documents ready.
☐	Property taxes and insurance estimates	Used to figure your true monthly cost of ownership.
☐	Leases and rent roll, if part of the building is leased to others	Lenders look at how much of the building your business occupies.
☐	Construction budget, plans, and contractor contract, if renovating or building	Lenders often require a construction budget with a contingency.
☐	Your current rent	Helps show how owning compares to renting.

Business acquisition

	Document	Notes
☐	Letter of intent or purchase agreement	Include the price, what is included, and any seller financing.
☐	Seller's business tax returns, usually the last 3 years	Lenders typically underwrite the business's historical cash flow.
☐	Seller's interim financial statements	Year to date, plus the same period last year.
☐	List of assets being purchased and allocation of the purchase price	Equipment, inventory, real estate, goodwill.
☐	Business valuation, if required	Some loans and lenders require an independent valuation.
☐	Buyer's resume and industry experience	Lenders want to know who will run the business.
☐	Proof of your down payment (equity injection)	Bank or brokerage statements showing where the money comes from.
☐	Seller note terms, if any	Amount, rate, payment, and whether payments are on standby.
☐	Transition plan and non-compete terms	How long the seller stays on and what they agree not to do.
☐	New lease or lease assignment	If the business rents its location.
☐	Customer list and concentration (can be anonymized early on)	Share of sales from top customers.
☐	Projections for the first 1 to 3 years under your ownership	Show changes you plan to make, such as your own salary.

SBA 7(a) or 504

	Document	Notes
☐	Everything in the core list, plus the list for your loan purpose above	SBA loans add forms and eligibility checks on top of normal underwriting.
☐	SBA Form 1919, Borrower Information Form (7(a) loans)	Completed by the business and its owners. sba.gov/document/sba-form-1919-borrower-information-form
☐	SBA Form 1244, Application for Section 504 Loans (504 loans)	Your Certified Development Company (CDC) will guide you. sba.gov/document/sba-form-1244-application-section-504-loans
☐	SBA Form 413, Personal Financial Statement	Your lender may accept its own PFS form instead. Ask. sba.gov/document/sba-form-413-personal-financial-statement
☐	Other SBA forms your lender requests	For example, Form 912 (Statement of Personal History) in some situations. Your lender will tell you which forms apply.
☐	Documentation of owner citizenship or residency status	SBA updated its ownership citizenship and residency requirements effective March 1, 2026. Ask your lender what they need.
☐	Source of your equity injection (down payment)	Statements showing the money is yours and where it came from.
☐	Franchise agreement and disclosure document, if a franchise	Search the SBA Franchise Directory on SBA.gov to see if the brand is listed.
☐	Business plan and projections, especially for startups and acquisitions	Plain, realistic assumptions beat optimistic ones.
☐	List of any current or past government-backed financing	Including any past SBA, USDA, or disaster loans.

Tips that save time

- Make one folder (paper or digital) per loan request and name files clearly, like "2025 Business Tax Return.pdf".
- Send complete returns, with every page and schedule. Missing schedules are one of the most common delays.
- If something in your numbers looks unusual (a big one-time expense, a slow year), write a short note explaining it.
- Ask your lender for their own checklist early. Use this one to get a head start, not as a substitute.

Please note

Commonly requested; each lender differs. This checklist is educational only. It is not an application, an offer of credit, or a promise of approval. SBA forms and rules change; confirm current requirements at [SBA.gov](https://sba.gov) or with your lender.